

HENRY MELLER

Meller's Quiet Return to Form

A second-best gross round of his TEG career drags Henry Meller back into touching distance of the Wooden Spoon exit, even as he remains rooted last.

Henry Meller arrived at TEG 3's third round anchored to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon table. Two blow-up-heavy rounds had defined his tournament to that point. On Tuesday at Boavista, with nobody watching and nothing left to protect, he produced the best golf of the day.

The turnaround was stark. A level-par round three followed a second round that had bled ten shots to par. The engine room was a run from the 3rd to the 5th: three holes played without dropping a single gross shot, each

par worth a shot to his net score. Nothing of the kind had appeared on his card all tournament.

It did not last. A double bogey at the 6th, one of the harder holes on the course, ended the run as briskly as it had been assembled. The damage was contained, though, and the round stood as a rare bright spot. It narrowed his gap to the next-worst Spoon contender from fifteen shots to eight. It did nothing whatsoever to move him off the bottom.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY Gregg WILLIAMS (-1)
TROPHY LEAD Gregg WILLIAMS, 5 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD David MULLIN, 14 ahead

ROUND NET VP
GW -1 HM 0 JB +2 SN +7 DM +12
ROUND GROSS
HM +20 JB +24 DM +27 SN +27 GW +32

AFTER R3 • TROPHY
GW -5 JB 0 SN +4 DM +5 HM +13
AFTER R3 • GREEN JACKET
DM +50 SN +64 JB +66 HM +73 GW +94

DAVID MULLIN | GREGG WILLIAMS

Mullin's Long Reign Ends

A three-hole capitulation costs David Mullin the TEG 5 Trophy lead he had held since the first evening, and Gregg Williams' composed round turns a three-shot gap into a five-shot cushion.

David Mullin's hold on the TEG 5 Trophy lead had stood since the 18th hole of round one. Twenty-one holes out in front. It took him three holes at the start of round three to give it all back.

A triple bogey at the 2nd. Double bogeys at the 3rd and the 4th. Seven gross shots gone, and not one net par among them. Gregg Williams, meanwhile,

made his move at the 3rd with a routine par on the par-5. It was worth two shots net against par, and it was enough to take the lead outright. He did not have to do anything clever. He simply had to keep standing.

By the close of the round Williams held the Trophy by five, a three-shot deficit overturned

without visible effort. Mullin's card never recovered. A quadruple bogey nine at the 13th finished the job on the way to twelve over, his worst round of the TEG. It followed a strong second round, a sixteen-shot swing in form, and no obvious explanation. Mullin still leads the Green Jacket by fourteen. For the first time in the tournament, he is the one doing the chasing.

JON BAKER | STUART NEUMANN

The 18th Claims Two Victims

Jon Baker and Stuart Neumann both close with quintuple-bogey nines on Boavista's 18th, the final indignity in two otherwise ordinary rounds gone wrong.

Round three at Boavista ended in a piece of symmetry that neither man will want framed. Jon Baker and Stuart Neumann both closed with quintuple-bogey nines at the 18th. Mirror images, right down to the identical result.

Baker's was his second nine of the day. He had already run one up at the 7th, which lends the card a certain rhythm. The rest of it was not

without promise, which is the cruellest thing one can say about it.

Neumann's disaster was the end of a longer process. He bled ten shots over the last three holes: a double bogey at the 16th, a triple at the 17th, then the nine at the last. Each hole was a slightly more ambitious version of the one before.

The 18th is a stroke index 5 hole and no pushover. Even so, two nines from two different players on the same green in the same round is a rare coincidence. Neither man's history here suggests it was typical, and both have posted far better gross totals at Boavista. In round three, though, the closing hole had the final word for both of them.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 5, Round 3

PERSONAL WORSTS

- David Mullin's worst round to date: +12
- David Mullin — +9 net-vs-par on the Back nine is a personal-worst Back nine net-vs-par